

AUM RECONCILIATION PLATFORM

From Monolith to Microservices

Stakeholder management, scoping, prioritization and defining success for the V2 → V3 migration.

JC

Jessica Castro

Product Manager · Business Case Submission

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PLATFORM

AUM Reconciliation V2 → V3

COMPANY

Bitso

WHAT'S INSIDE

How this case is structured

The answers are presented directly in this document. The full ideation process, reasoning, artifacts, diagrams, and visual maps are documented on the Miro board linked below. Reading both together provides the complete picture.

SECTION 01

Case Resolution Framework

The process followed during the 5 days. How I read the case, structured my thinking, used AI as a copilot, and built the artifacts.

PROCESS

SECTION 02

Understanding the Problem

CSD Matrix, Stakeholder Map, C4 Platform Diagrams V2 and V3. Artifacts used to frame the problem before answering any question.

CONTEXT

SECTION 03 - QUESTION 1

Stakeholder Management

How to re-engage the Ops team, rebuild trust, co-define health metrics and establish a long-term engagement strategy.

Q1

SECTION 04 - QUESTION 2

Scoping Under Ambiguity

How to scope a migration with no estimate across 19+ providers, 150+ currencies, 5 countries while the system stays online.

Q2

SECTION 05 - QUESTION 3

Prioritization

How to manage V2 in production and V3 in progress at the same time, and what principle drives every tough call.

Q3

SECTION 06 - QUESTION 4

Defining Success

How to determine V3 delivered its value: metrics connected to business objectives, and what V3 can worsen while improving others.

Q4



Full process documented on Miro. CSD Matrix, Stakeholder Map, C4 diagrams V2 + V3, retro templates, lag x accuracy diagram, health metrics proposal, engagement timeline and migration plan. Read from left to right, top to bottom.

miro.com/app/board/uXjVK5aYguw=

THE PROCESS

How I approached this case

A 5-day structured process combining discovery, research, synthesis and design, using AI as a critical assistant.

STEP 01**Understand the problem**

Read attentively. Underline key words. Map questions. Use the Matrix FHD — Facts, Hypotheses, Doubts — to structure the analysis.

STEP 02**Build core answers**

Identify crucial items vs. open questions. Select Product methodologies, bibliographical sources and references. Write the answers.

STEP 03**Create artifacts**

After researching and writing, create the images, diagrams and visuals. Reviewed the English and refined storytelling.

STEP 04**Design and submit**

Design the final presentation. Review the Miro board and the presentation together. Submit.



AI as critical assistant, not author. Two AI models were used simultaneously (Gemini and Claude) for: vocabulary comprehension in a non-native language, desk research on market environment and regulatory aspects, technical concept validation, and visual preparation. The reasoning, hypotheses, and insights are entirely my own.

DISCOVERY ARTIFACTS

Before answering, I drew the map.

Three artifacts were built during the discovery phase to understand the problem, the people, and the platform before structuring any answer. Each one served a specific purpose across the four questions.



Matrix FHD

Facts · Hypotheses · Doubts

Used to cluster what was already known from the case, what needed to be validated through research, and what remained open. As doubts were clarified through desk research and AI-assisted discovery, they moved into facts or hypotheses. The hypotheses built on this matrix are the foundation of all four answers.

USED IN [All 4 questions](#)



Map of Stakeholders

Power, influence and proximity

Built using the concentric rings model to understand the dynamics of power and connection inside and outside the organisation. Maps who is directly involved, who is impacted secondarily, and who operates in the outer layer. Essential for understanding the human and political dimension of the migration and for structuring the engagement strategy.

USED IN [Q1](#) [Q2](#) [Q3](#)



Platform and Operation Map

C4 Model · V2 and V3

Drawing the platform was the most important act of understanding in this case. A platform PM cannot manage what they cannot map. The C4 model was used to diagram V2 as it is — exposing the monolith's dependencies, timing misalignment and operational problems — and V3 as it will be, with the event-driven architecture and the proposed PM layer on top.

USED IN [Q2](#) [Q3](#)

THE DIAGNOSIS AND THE ANSWER

"This is not a technical case, it is a political negotiation."

HOW DO YOU ADDRESS THIS?

As one of the main direct customers of the platform, the Payment Operations team has lost confidence in the product. To navigate the migration with their sponsorship, the answer is a 4-step strategy: re-engage and listen first, explain the need to migrate in their language, write the rules of the game together, and commit to a long-term engagement that sustains the relationship throughout and after the migration.

Core Hypothesis: Establishing a solid shared understanding of health metrics for the platform with the operations team and observability standards is required for the migration to start. Metrics build a shared language. They set the rules of the game.

STEP 1

Re-engage and Listen

Hot Air Balloon retro session. Psychological safety first. Unbiased discovery with internal customers, before proposing anything.

STEP 2

Speak their language

Explain the migration need without jargon. Jenga Tower vs. Lego Spaceship, a visual metaphor the Ops team can understand and relate to.

STEP 3

Write the terms and conditions

Co-define platform health metrics and SLOs with all relevant stakeholders. The Operations team co-owns the standards. Metrics replace escalation with alignment.

STEP 4

Long Term Engagement Strategy

Not just one retro. A commitment to rebuild and nurture the relationship over time through recurring rituals, progress reporting, CSAT checkpoints and V2 improvements in parallel.



Full answer, artifacts and visual maps on Miro: https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVK5aYguw=

STEP 3 · WRITE THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS

A starting point for the conversation, not a decree.

We know the Ops team wants near-real-time solvency. We arrive at the session with benchmarked proposals so we are not starting from zero. These numbers are a position, not a mandate. They exist to ground the discussion and be challenged, refined and co-owned by all stakeholders at the table.

PROPOSED SLOS — BENCHMARKED FROM INDUSTRY

Metric	Proposed SLO	Reference
Reconciliation lag p95 per currency	10 seconds max 5% tolerance	BIS real-time payments · BCB/Pix
Match accuracy per reconciliation cycle	97% minimum	ISO 20022 Design Science Research
Alert noise rate manual vs. auto-resolved	80% auto-resolved	ISO 20022 · 80% reduction benchmark

WHAT WE DO NOT COMMIT TO

100% accuracy, zero lag, real-time in absolute sense. Technically impossible in any distributed system at scale. Committing to them would repeat the trust-breaking cycle.

KEY INSIGHT · LAG AND ACCURACY ARE COUPLED

Timing misalignment between provider responses is the **root cause** of accuracy gaps. A platform that reports slowly will also report inaccurately. The lag SLO controls both and they must be defined together, not independently.

WHY WE BRING NUMBERS TO THE TABLE

There is already a desire for real-time solvency from the Ops team. Arriving with benchmarked proposals means the discussion starts grounded in industry data rather than emotional expectations. The numbers can change. The conversation must happen.

POSSIBLE IMPROVEMENTS TO EXPLORE TOGETHER

Based on the retro session findings, there may be opportunities to reduce alert noise and improve the ops experience in V2 before V3 ships. These are not commitments. They are candidates for discussion, prioritised by business impact if **validated**. *No promises, best effort.*



Lag x Accuracy diagram, SLO proposal and benchmarks on Miro: https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVK5aYguw=

STEP 4 · NURTURE THE RELATIONSHIP

Trust is rebuilt through consistency, not promises.

The retro session and the SLO co-definition session are the beginning. What sustains the relationship is a system of recurring touchpoints that keeps the Ops team close, informed, and heard throughout the migration and beyond. This is not a one-time gesture. It is a long-term commitment.

WEEKLY

Traffic Light Report

Platform health vs SLO, V3 migration progress, V2 incidents resolved. Short, visual, no jargon. Shared in the company communication channel.

PER MILESTONE

Migration Updates

At each provider migration milestone: what moved, what was validated in shadow mode, what is next. The Ops team is never surprised by a change.

QUARTERLY

Retro Session

Hot Air Balloon format recurring. Continuous discovery loop. The Ops team stays in the feedback cycle, not just the receiving end.

AT 50% AND 100% DELIVERY

CSAT Survey

A short satisfaction survey at two moments. Measures whether trust was actually rebuilt, not just whether the platform works technically. CSAT over NPS: measures satisfaction, not recommendation likelihood.

THROUGHOUT MIGRATION · BEST EFFORT

V2 Improvements in Parallel

20% of the team's capacity reserved for quick wins and V2 improvements identified during the retro session. Communicated together with migration progress. *No promises, best effort, prioritised by business impact.*



Engagement Timeline visual on Miro: https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVK5aYguw=

HOW | APPROACH SCOPING

The solution is designed. What is missing is the delivery plan.

Engineering understands the V3 architecture. What does not exist yet is a scoped delivery plan. The starting point is the platform map built in Section 2. From there, the process involves the right people, the right questions, and a clear output.

WHO | INVOLVE

CORE TEAM

Engineering

EM · 5 Seniors · Staff · estimation and refinement

CORE TEAM

DevOps / SRE

Observability setup · delivery effort · rollback plans

VALIDATE

Legal / Regulatory

Deadlines and constraints that impact prioritization

CORE TEAM

Data Team

Schema mapping · event store · DB interfaces from day one

CORE TEAM

Security and Infra

Compliance during transition · no extra steps added

VALIDATE

Business Stakeholders

Prioritization logic · risk assumptions · business impact

QUESTIONS THAT MUST BE ANSWERED BEFORE A CREDIBLE ROADMAP

- ? What is our migration plan and strategy to sunset V2?
- ? Do providers have different technological natures and migration complexities?
- ? Should we migrate in a specific sequence to minimize risk?
- ? What is the API documentation quality and complexity per provider?
- ? Are there holidays or leave periods planned during delivery?
- ? Are there strategic company projects that impact prioritization?
- ? Are there regulatory or security constraints to consider before planning?
- ? Which providers process the highest volume and generate the most errors?
- ? What is the current V2 onboarding time per provider?
- ? What is the rollback plan per provider if something goes wrong?
- ? What does shadow mode success look like before flipping the switch?
- ? What observability tooling must be built before shadow mode can start?

PROCESS

- 1 High Level Technical Refinement**
Break V3 into milestone EPICs with the full engineering team. Business stakeholders validate prioritization and risk assumptions.
- 2 Classify and estimate per tier**
Group 19+ providers into complexity tiers. Run a pilot per tier. Use outputs as calibration baseline for the remaining providers.
- 3 Build the roadmap and migration plan**
Sequence providers by Pareto impact and risk. Include shadow mode milestones, rollback plans and V2 product sunset.

 Full scoping rationale and migration plan on Miro: <https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVK5aYguw/>

THE DELIVERY PLAN

The scoping output is a Migration Plan treated as a project.

Once the questions are answered and the team is aligned, the output is a structured delivery plan with capacity defined upfront, providers classified by complexity, and a clear path from V2 to V3 with the platform always online.

CAPACITY MODEL · NON-NEGOTIABLE



■ V3 delivery, always protected ■ Unplanned, operational insurance ■ Quick wins and V2 improvements

PROVIDER TIERS FOR ESTIMATION

Tier A · Crypto Custodians and Wallets

Modern APIs · pilot calibration unit · V3 Reconciliation Engine core built during this phase

STARTS FIRST

Tier B · International Payment Rails

High volume · operational risk · latency problems · Pareto priority

COMPLEX

Tier C · Traditional Bank Accounts

Legacy APIs · V2 engine fully decommissioned only after all 150+ currencies stable on V3 stream

MIGRATES LAST

10 to 20% buffer added to all estimates, named explicitly to leadership. Not hidden.

SCOPING OUTPUT DELIVERABLES

- Provider migration priority list, Pareto first
- Sprint breakdown per complexity tier
- Release plan with shadow mode milestones per provider
- Rollback plan per provider
- V2 Product Sunset plan with deprecation criteria and decommission sign-off
- Roadmap communicated to all stakeholders

HOW WE COMMUNICATE TO LEADERSHIP

We have built a full strategy to keep the platform running during the entire migration. The migration plan, rollback plans and risk mitigation strategies are available for review at any time. The roadmap already accounts for a 20% buffer. If a new risk or regulatory request emerges, we have capacity reserved for exactly that. Regular progress reports keep leadership informed at every step.



Full migration plan, C4 diagrams and Product Sunset on Miro: https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVK5aYguw=

THE FRAMEWORK

Solvency and business growth always win.

When a tough call must be made between V2 and V3, the answer is anchored to the same SLO the team agreed with stakeholders. That shared language does the work, not politics, not pressure.

WHAT PAUSES V3

- Critical V2 bug blocking the reconciliation engine
- Solvency breach or accuracy SLO violation
- Regulatory deadline with legal consequences
- Security incident putting operations at risk
- Major business need that cannot yet be handled by V3 infrastructure

WHAT ACCELERATES V3

- Stability, no new providers, no incidents frees full V3 velocity
- Migrating Pareto providers first — each high-impact provider migrated reduces V2 burden and builds confidence at the same time
- Optimising and self-resolving discrepancy reports

CAN BOTH PROGRESS IN PARALLEL?

Short answer: yes.

Dividing capacity between building tomorrow and sustaining today is what makes it all possible and negotiable. Even with 60% for V3 and 20% for V2, that split can be redistributed whenever solvency demands it, regardless of which architecture calls first. The Strangler Fig Pattern makes parallel progress structural, not aspirational.

COMMUNICATING COMPETING PRIORITIES

The roadmap is the shared contract.

All items on the roadmap are connected to the success metrics and solvency maintenance as the company scales. Stakeholders are invited to flag issues they believe impact the platform or SLOs and we evaluate together. No item changes unless it brings more value than an established one. The metrics replace politics.

THE PREMISE

Success starts at discovery. Measured at delivery.

Success metrics were structured considering business growth projections because no rational company migrates a critical platform while assuming zero growth. The specific numbers (+50% YoY volume, +1 country, +20 currencies) are hypothetical premises to be validated with Finance and Business before locking.

Metric	Why it matters	Success value	Frequency
BUSINESS Transaction volume sustained	Migration cannot become a revenue problem	No volume drop attributable to AUM incidents	Monthly
BUSINESS Business expansion accelerated	V3 reduces onboarding friction — we stop being the bottleneck	1 new country onboarded faster than V2 baseline	Per event
BUSINESS Monitor accuracy · no solvency incidents	Regulatory requirement and daily operations foundation	Zero solvency breaches · accuracy SLO maintained	Continuous
PLATFORM Reconciliation lag (p95)	Root cause of accuracy gaps, coupled metric	SLO agreed with business stakeholders	Continuous
PLATFORM Alert noise rate	150 raw reports leads to ops toil and trust erosion	Significant reduction vs. V2 baseline	Weekly
OPERATIONS Provider onboarding time	The architectural promise made concrete	Zero engine changes · measurable lead time reduction	Per event
OPERATIONS Ops team satisfaction (CSAT)	If trust is not rebuilt, the migration failed in practice	Improvement between 50% and 100% delivery milestones	2 milestones

HONEST ASSESSMENT

Yes. Named explicitly. Monitored from day one.

A domain-specific microservices architecture has clear advantages and real tradeoffs. Naming them is not a weakness. It is what distinguishes a PM who understands the system from one who just delivered it.

V3 IMPROVES

- **Accuracy:** precise timestamps, no more heuristic workarounds
- **Lag:** continuous event stream replaces scheduled polling
- **Provider onboarding:** new service, zero engine changes
- **Scalability:** each service scales independently
- **Alert quality:** PM layer enables smart grouping and auto-resolution

V3 CAN WORSEN

- **Operational complexity:** 19+ services to monitor vs. one monolith
- **Security patching:** one vulnerability means N deployments needed
- **Regulatory changes:** a new rule affecting all providers requires N updates
- **Systemic changes:** improvements affecting all providers done one service at a time
- **Infrastructure cost:** more services means more compute
- **Observability cost and cognitive load:** distributed tracing, centralized logging, correlation IDs across every service. Without it, debugging one discrepancy means hunting across 19 logs at the same time